Amongst other benefits the Shah has received from our doctor's (Dr Bell) treatment (I say *our* because I do not think the Russian is much of a doctor) is that he has cleared his nose in such a manner that those who were not well accustomed to speak with him could not understand him. I was most agreeably surprised on entering the room to find that I could understand all he said and talked away in a manner that appeared to surprise some of the courtiers who expect a man to be rather abashed when first presented.

I dine with Coll Sheil two or three times a week and have dined once with Prince Dolgorouki,[103] the Russian Envoy, and once with Count de Sartiges the French agent. The latter's dinners are by far the most agreeable. He is a man of about forty and has been travelling attached to different missions all his life. He gave me some curious facts about the slaves in north and south America, where he has travelled much.

Tehran, May 7, 1846

I wrote to you last month from this place and then hoped to have addressed my next from Tabreez. You will see by the date that I am still here, and as yet I have been able to get nothing done, however I have yet hopes, but this life of loitering about the court and attending the Prime ministers levies is to me a most miserable one. It is very true that in all countries a man who has business with great people must expect to kick his heels about lobbies and ante-rooms, but then in Europe there is this great difference that the man you are dancing attendance upon, generally speaking, is not one who excites nothing but contempt, I can not tell you the misery I sometimes feel whilst I am waiting for an opportunity to speak to the Hadji (Prime Minister) on my affairs, altho I see Princes of the blood no better off than I am; and therefore I sometimes think that this feeling of annoyance is one that I ought to get over. One reason why I have never been able to come to any arrangement with my creditors is that they are affraid to come to any settlement with me until the Govt have made some arrangement with Charles because they consider the government as first creditor. This is one amongst the difficulties with which I have to contend, but it would be neither entertaining nor useful to any one to trouble you with any more of these details, at present. If I can do any thing satisfactory you may be sure I shall not fail to let you know.

We have very little news in this dull place. The Shah whose death you saw announced last autumn is now pretty free from gout and in very good health, the French doctor who formerly treated him and left Persia with a fortune has

[103] Dmitri Ivanovich Dolgorouki, 1816–1867, member of the famous family of that name. A "career" diplomat, he had held posts in almost all the capitals of Europe and the Near East.

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